Self-management Skills

The big idea

Self-management is the ability to control your own thoughts, emotions, behaviour and time so you can reach your goals. A self-managed person is confident, well-groomed, organised and positive. In Class 9 you study **personality**, **self-confidence**, **positive thinking** and **personal grooming and hygiene**.

Self-management skills

Important self-management skills include:

- **Self-awareness** – knowing your strengths and weaknesses.
- **Self-control** – managing emotions like anger.
- **Self-confidence** – believing in your abilities.
- **Problem solving**, **self-motivation**, **personal hygiene**, **positive thinking**, **team work** and **time management**.

Personality

Personality is the set of qualities (thoughts, feelings, behaviour) that make a person unique. It is shaped by **heredity, environment, family, friends, school and culture**.

THE BIG FIVE PERSONALITY TRAITS (OCEAN)

- **O**penness – curious, likes new ideas.
- **C**onscientiousness – organised, responsible.
- **E**xtraversion – outgoing, energetic.

- **A**greeableness – friendly, kind, cooperative.
- **N**euroticism – tends to feel anxious or moody (the opposite is emotional stability).

Some common problems that hold people back are **shyness**, **fear**, **low confidence** and **anxiety**. These can be reduced with practice, support and positive thinking.

Self-confidence

Self-confidence is trust in your own abilities and judgement. Confident people speak up, try new things and accept mistakes.

Steps to build self-confidence:

1. **Know your strengths** and list your achievements.
2. **Set small, achievable goals** and complete them.
3. **Think positive** and stop comparing yourself with others.
4. **Prepare well** before tests, speeches or interviews.
5. **Learn from mistakes** instead of fearing them.
6. Stay **well-groomed** – looking neat helps you feel confident.

CONFIDENCE IS NOT OVERCONFIDENCE

Confidence comes with preparation and respect for others. Overconfidence ignores preparation and often leads to failure.

Positive thinking

Positive thinking means expecting good results and seeing problems as chances to learn. Tips: start the day with something you are grateful for, stay with positive people, replace "I can't" with "I'll try", and take care of your health.

Personal grooming and hygiene

Grooming means keeping yourself neat and presentable: clean, ironed clothes, polished shoes, tidy hair, trimmed nails.
Personal hygiene keeps you healthy and confident:

- Bathe daily and wash hands before eating and after using the toilet.
- Brush teeth twice a day.
- Wear clean clothes and socks.
- Cover your mouth while coughing or sneezing.

Healthy living also means **exercise**, a **balanced diet** and **8 hours of sleep**.

REMEMBER THE THREE STEPS OF HYGIENE

Care (keep your body clean), Wash (hands, clothes, body) and Avoid (germs, sharing personal items like towels and combs).

Quick recap

- Self-management = controlling your thoughts, feelings, behaviour and time.
- Personality: unique qualities; Big Five = OCEAN.
- Build confidence through strengths, small goals, preparation and positive thinking.
- Grooming and hygiene boost health and confidence.

Practice questions

1. In the Big Five personality traits, the letter C stands for
   (a) Creativity (b) Conscientiousness (c) Confidence (d) Cooperation
2. A person who is outgoing and enjoys meeting people shows high
   (a) neuroticism (b) conscientiousness (c) extraversion (d) openness
3. Which of the following helps build self-confidence?
   (a) Comparing yourself with toppers all the time (b) Avoiding all new challenges (c) Setting small goals and achieving them (d) Ignoring your strengths
4. Which is a good personal hygiene habit?
   (a) Washing hands before eating (b) Sharing towels with friends (c) Brushing teeth once a week (d) Wearing the same socks for days
5. Personality is influenced by
   (a) heredity only (b) environment only (c) both heredity and environment (d) neither heredity nor environment
6. Replacing "I can't do it" with "I'll try my best" is an example of
   (a) grooming (b) extraversion (c) time management (d) positive thinking
7. What is self-confidence? Write any two ways to build it.
8. Why are grooming and personal hygiene important? List four good hygiene practices.

Answers: 1. b 2. c 3. c 4. a 5. c 6. d 7. see notes 8. see notes